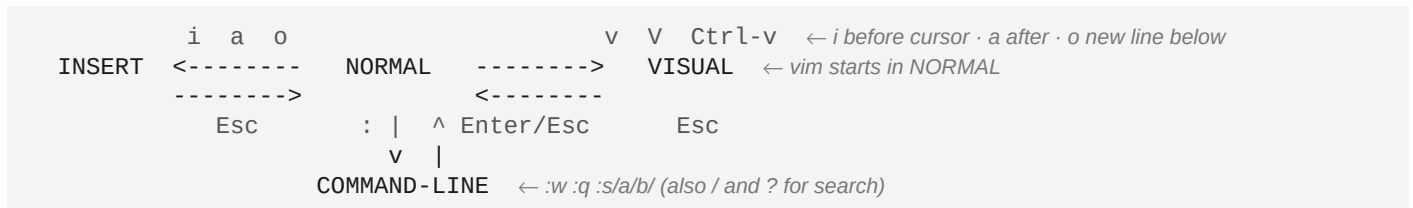


vim Cheat Sheet

A keyboard-only text editor: keys move and edit in Normal mode, and you type text in Insert mode.

The modes



Saving and quitting (type in Normal mode)

Type	Does	Type	Does
:w	Saves	:q!	Quits and throws away changes
:q	Quits (refuses if there are unsaved changes)	:w name	Saves as a new file name
:wq or :x	Saves and quits	ZZ	Saves and quits (no colon, no Enter)

Moving

Key	Moves	Key	Moves
h j k l	Left, down, up, right	gg / G / 42G	First line / last line / line 42
w / b / e	Next word / back a word / end of word	Ctrl-d/u	Down / up half a screen
0 / ^ / \$	Line start / first non-blank / line end	%	Jumps to the matching bracket

Editing

Key	Does	Key	Does
x	Deletes the character under the cursor	u / Ctrl-r	Undo / redo
dd	Deletes (cuts) the line	.	Repeats the last change
yy	Copies (yanks) the line	cw	Changes to the end of the word (then type)
p / P	Pastes after / before the cursor	ciw	Changes the whole word under the cursor
dw / D	Deletes a word / to the end of the line	>> / <<	Indents / un-indents the line

The grammar: [count] operator motion

Type	Means	Type	Means
d3w	delete 3 words	y\$	yank to end of line (\$)
5dd	Delete 5 lines	dG	Delete to the end of the file

Operators: **d** delete, **c** change, **y** yank, **>** indent. Doubling one (**dd yy cc >>**) acts on the whole line.

Search and replace

Type	Does	Type	Does
/word / ?word	Searches forward / backward	:s/a/b/g	Replaces a with b on this line (g = all)
n / N	Next / previous match	:%s/a/b/g	Replaces in the whole file (%)
*	Searches for the word under the cursor	:%s/a/b/gc	Same, but asks y/n for each match
		:5,10s/a/b/g	Replaces on lines 5–10 only

Visual mode and handy commands

Type	Does	Type	Does
v v Ctrl-v	Selects characters / lines / a block	:set number	Shows line numbers
:sp / :vs	Splits the window across / side by side	:set paste	Pasting won't auto-indent
Ctrl-w w	Jumps to the next split window	:noh	Clears search highlighting
:e file	Opens another file	d y c >	In Visual mode: act on the selection

Remember: Stuck? Press **Esc** twice, then type **:q!** and Enter to quit without saving.